A-A-50877A
29 April 1988
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50877
31 May 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ELECTRODE, ELECTROSURGICAL APPARATUS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a sterile, disposable electrode handle with integral cord suitable for use with electrosurgical units.

Salient characteristics:

The unit shall be sterile, disposable, integral handle/blade electrode suitable for use in electrosurgical procedures.

The handle shall be fabricated of a suitable plastic material. The design and construction of the handle shall be such as to render it slip-resistant and permit easy gripping and handling during surgical procedures. The handle shall be of waterproof sealed construction to protect both operator and patient from potential current leakage or accidental generator activation due to fluid entry. The handle shall be fitted with a blade approximately one (1) inch (2.54 cm) in length, fabricated from a suitable corrosion-resisting steel wire.

The cord shall have an approximate length of ten feet (3 m) and shall be suitably insulated. It shall be neither so stiff that it impedes manipulation, nor so flexible that it tangles easily. The cord shall have a formed male fitting to provide a connection with an adapter (not included) fitting into the active outlet of the electrosurgical apparatus.

The cable insulation shall prevent excess current flow to medical personnel or to the patient during electrosurgery; current density shall be less than 100 mA/cm^2.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Workmanship. The electrode shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 48 assemblies, as specified, constitutes one unit. Each assembly shall be packaged in a peel-back type container capable of maintaining sterility of contents until manually opened.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on the electrode when a first article sample is required. This inspection shall include the examination and tests.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be one electrode.

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Defects.

Metal fitting not adequately secured to cord.

Handle not free of cracks, ruptures, and deformed sections.

Cord insulation not free of tears, cracks or breaks.

Ends of cord not free of exposed wire at points of entrance into handle or fitting.

Handle interior not free of obstructions to chuck component.

Unit not free of dirt, grease and foreign matter.

Cord not flexible as required.

Container not properly sealed to prevent contamination of inner contents.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.5 (percent defective) and inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one electrode.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

1. Dielectric strength test. A potential of 6000 volts peak to peak at 60 Hz shall be applied between the handle and cord conductor and a metal plate or other suitable electrode. The handle and at least one foot of cord shall be in intimate contact with the metal plate. There shall be no evidence of breakdown with the potential applied for one minute.

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2. Strain relief test. The handle shall be secured in place and a force gage attached to the cord. A straight pull shall be applied to the cord parallel to the long axis of the handle until a force of 9 pounds has been reached. The metal fitting on the end of the cord shall be secured and a force gage attached to the cord. A straight pull shall be applied to the cord until a force of 9 pounds is reached. Disconnection of the cord from either the handle or the fitting shall constitute failure of the test.

3. Electrode insertion test. The handle shall be grasped in one hand and a blade electrode shall be inserted into the chuck with the other hand. A straight force shall be used without twisting. Failure of the electrode to seat in and be securely held by the chuck shall constitute failure of this test. The necessity to use greater than normal hand force to seat the electrode shall constitute failure of the test. The depth of insertion of the shaft into the handle shall not exceed 1-1/4 inch.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6515-01-010-4121

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4210

PGC 46881

Location: CID/ELECTRODE/HlD

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-50877A	ELECTRODE, ELECTROSURGICAL APPARATUS

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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